

BEYOND THE KINGDOM

Episode #0007

Air Date: Tuesday, January 11, 2005

Prod. #BTK-0007

Story Day: Tuesday, January 11, 2005 (7:02 AM - 10:58 PM
EST)

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0007

(ages as of Tuesday, January 11, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68) · JOAN DONOHUE (66)

THE OLSONS: MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23)

THE SMILLEYS: ODESSA SMILLEY (84) · LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49) · DESMOND SMILLEY (48) · LUKE SMILLEY (28) · DELPHINE SMILLEY-ASHE (25) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22)

THE BAKERS: CURTIS BAKER (50) · GLORIA BAKER (48) · KIARA BAKER (15)

THE CHILDREN: EMMA SMILLEY (2) · VICTORIA SMILLEY (2) · LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22)

THE SEVEN: TOBIAS "THE LEDGER" OKAFOR (24) · KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25)

RECURRING: INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47) · CAMILLE RHODES (38) · DEPUTY CHIEF WARREN HUGHES (46) · FORMER CHIEF HAROLD JACKSON (57) · THADDEUS CROWE (40) · BEATRIX "NANNY BEA" PENNINGTON (43) · VINCE MARETTI (36) · LORETTA DIVINE (49)

DAY PLAYERS: WENDELL SUTTLES (General Counsel, Donohue Shipping) · DONNA KEEL · MISTY CALLOWAY (Keel agent) · PHIL (Keel agent) · SMILLEY VALET · RAVENHURST MAID · SMILLEY CORPORATE SECRETARY · NATHANIEL GREER (by phone) · FLORIST DELIVERY MAN · NATASHA'S ASSISTANT (V.O.)

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Quentin Smilley (asleep) · Grace Bullock · Denise Jackson · Alvin Donohue (Miami) · Darnell "Dee" Divine · Gerald Pettaway (Harbour Point)

FADE IN:

TEASER

**1 INT. DONOHUE TOWER – VICTOR'S OFFICE – 88TH FLOOR –
MORNING**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 7:02 AM EST

The top of Donohue Tower. A corner office the size of a chapel: walnut paneling, a partners' desk that belonged to Alexander, and floor-to-ceiling glass. Across Peachtree Road, the gold crown of Smilley Tower catches the first light.

VICTOR DONOHUE (68) stands at the window in a charcoal three-piece suit, freshly shaved. Nobody would guess he slept on a Chesterfield. Night six starts tonight.

Behind him, WENDELL SUTTLES (60s), General Counsel of Donohue Shipping, gray-haired and careful, sits on the edge of a leather chair holding an accordion file on his knees like a hymnal. He drove up from Savannah at four in the morning.

VICTOR
(not turning)
Harbour Point Logistics.

SUTTLES
Yes, sir. I brought everything we keep in Savannah. Corporate minutes, the 1998 purchase agreement, the bonds, the customs licenses.

VICTOR
And the designation letters.

A small pause.

SUTTLES
Sir?

VICTOR
(turning)
Harbour Point's bank account at Chatham Savings lets "such other agents as the parent company may designate in writing" sign for it. I want every letter anybody at this company has ever written designating an agent.

SUTTLES

(opening the file,
flipping)

Gerald Pettaway kept all of that.
He was old-fashioned, sir. Paper,
carbon copies. When he went into
the nursing home in August, his
files went into storage in the
Garden City office.

VICTOR

Then drive to Garden City.

SUTTLES

Yes, sir.

(beat, hesitating)

Mr. Donohue. May I ask why?

VICTOR

No.

SUTTLES

(beat)

Of course.

(closing the file, then
stopping)

It's only that— You're the second
person to ask me for the Harbour
Point file this winter, sir. I
thought it was a coincidence.

Victor goes very still.

VICTOR

Who was the first?

SUTTLES

The request came in October, sir.
For the complete Harbour Point
file, including the bank
authorizations. I sent copies up
by courier.

(beat)

It came from your office.

VICTOR

(quietly)

My office.

SUTTLES

On letterhead. "Office of the
Chairman." I assumed you'd—

VICTOR
I did not request that file,
Wendell.

Silence. Suttles's face slowly drains.

SUTTLES
Sir, it was signed—

VICTOR
By whom?

SUTTLES
(beat)
I'd have to look. It was a stamp.
The Chairman's office uses a
stamp for routine—

VICTOR
Nothing that leaves my office is
routine.

He crosses to the desk. He presses a button on the phone.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
(into intercom)
Mrs. Ames. When you come in, I
want the log for every courier
delivery to this floor since
September first. Every one. On my
desk by nine.

He releases the button. He looks at Suttles.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Garden City. Today. You'll bring
me every designation letter in
Gerald Pettaway's boxes. You'll
bring me the courier receipt from
October. And you will not tell a
living soul at Donohue Shipping,
or at this company, or in your
own house, why you went.

SUTTLES
(standing)
Yes, sir.

He goes. The door closes.

Victor turns back to the window. Across the street, the
Smiley crown blazes gold.

VICTOR
(to himself, very
quietly)
Somebody's been in my house.

SMASH CUT TO:

**2 INT. HARMONY'S TOWNHOUSE — LINDBERGH — LIVING ROOM —
MORNING**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 7:19 AM EST

A small, bright townhouse full of toys. A playpen, a Dora the Explorer rug, and a dining table covered with MLS printouts and FIND DEE flyers.

On the couch lies a long flat garment box from Neiman Marcus, open. Tissue paper everywhere.

Harmony stands in front of the hall mirror in a navy St. John suit that fits her like it was cut on her body. It probably was. She's barefoot. Her hair's still in rollers.

LORETTA DIVINE (49), in Grady Hospital scrubs, stands behind her with Lyric on her hip. Lyric has a sippy cup in one hand and the giraffe in the other.

LORETTA
Lord, have mercy.

HARMONY
Is it too much?

LORETTA
It's too much for Lindbergh. It's
exactly enough for Buckhead.

Harmony turns sideways. She looks at herself.

HARMONY
Mama. I don't even know what I'm
doing today. She said, "Wear the
suit and look like you've already
been paid."

LORETTA
Then look like it.

HARMONY
I have eleven dollars in my
checking account.

LORETTA

Your face doesn't know that.

Lyric reaches for the suit with a sticky hand. Harmony dodges like a boxer.

HARMONY

No, ma'am! No, ma'am! That's
Neiman Marcus!

LYRIC

(delighted)

NEEMAN!

Loretta laughs. She sets Lyric on the rug and picks up a card from the tissue paper in the box: heavy cream stock, a single initial engraved: E.

LORETTA

(reading)

"Wear it like you own the
building. By lunch, you will."

HARMONY

(taking the card,
softly)

She's crazy.

LORETTA

She's your friend.

(beat)

Harmony. That girl bought you a
suit that costs more than my car.

HARMONY

I know.

LORETTA

Rich people don't buy you a suit
for nothing.

HARMONY

Esther's not "rich people," Mama.
She's Esther. She held my hair in
a dorm bathroom in Evanston.

LORETTA

(beat, gentle)

Rich people hold hair too, baby.

(kissing her forehead)

Go. I've got Lyric till Daddy
gets home. And I've got Friday on
the calendar in red.

HARMONY

Four o'clock.

LORETTA

Four o'clock. I'm making a pound cake for Ms. Mims.

HARMONY

Mama, she's an investigator, not the pastor.

LORETTA

She's looking for my son. She gets a pound cake.

Harmony pulls the rollers out one by one in the mirror. Behind her, her mother and her daughter watch.

She takes a breath. She stands up straight.

In the mirror, for the first time, she looks like somebody's already paid her.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES — "KINGDOM"

ACT ONE

3 EXT. SMILLEY TOWER — 3434 PEACHTREE ROAD NE — MORNING
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 8:51 AM EST

The gold-and-glass tower, seventy-two floors of new money on Peachtree Road. A doorman in a Smilley gray coat holds the brass door.

Across the sidewalk, behind a planter, VINCE MARETTI (36), paparazzo, in a Phillies cap and a camera vest, sips gas-station coffee with a long lens slung around his neck. He's bored.

The dented silver Honda Civic pulls up to the curb, blinker on, in a line of Bentleys and Town Cars.

A valet in gold gloves stares at it.

Harmony gets out in the navy St. John, sunglasses on, and hands him the keys.

HARMONY
(pleasantly)
It pulls a little to the left.

VALET
(uncertain)
Yes, ma'am.

She walks toward the door. Vince lowers his coffee. He squints.

VINCE
(to himself)
Who the hell are you?

He lifts the camera. CLICK-CLICK-CLICK. Harmony doesn't break stride.

The doorman opens the door. She disappears into the gold lobby.

Vince checks his screen. Harmony in mid-stride, chin up, like she owns the building.

VINCE (CONT'D)
(grinning)
Well, somebody's somebody now.

CUT TO:

4 INT. SMILLEY TOWER — 72ND FLOOR — THE BOARDROOM — DAY
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 9:02 AM EST

The top of the tower. A long boardroom of white onyx and gold. A table carved from a single piece of Italian marble, twenty-four white leather chairs, and a wall of glass looking directly across Peachtree at Donohue Tower.

On the wall behind the head of the table, the Smilley crest, an S entwined with a laurel, over the family motto: THE SMILE IS OURS.

The FAMILY COUNCIL of Smilley International is seated. The board's outside directors sit at the far end with water glasses and nervous faces.

At the head: LUCIUS SMILLEY (55), Chairman and CEO. His right hand rests on the table. His left hand is under it. Beside him, VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49), in black. Her right hand is under the table too.

To Lucius's left: ODESSA SMILLEY (84), in dove gray, with her ebony cane hooked on her chair.

Down one side: DESMOND SMILLEY (48), Lucius's brother, sleek and unreadable in a pinstripe suit. LUKE SMILLEY (28), Lucius's eldest son, handsome and already flushed. DELPHINE SMILLEY-ASHE (25), beautiful, lacquered, and bored on purpose.

An empty chair with a nameplate: QUENTIN SMILLEY.

At the far end, standing at an easel in a charcoal-gray suit: ESTHER SMILLEY (22). Gray is for war.

The SMILLEY CORPORATE SECRETARY (50s) takes minutes on a laptop.

ESTHER
(clicking to a slide)
Two billion dollars.

The slide: "SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL — ATLANTA REAL ESTATE PROGRAM, 2005. TARGET DEPLOYMENT: \$2.0 BILLION."

ESTHER (CONT'D)
Over the next twelve months.
Office, retail, residential,
land. Midtown. Buckhead. The
Beltline corridor that the city
hasn't approved yet but will. And
downtown.
(beat)

Especially downtown.

LUKE
(leaning back)
Downtown is Donohue.

ESTHER
Downtown was Donohue.

A murmur from the outside directors. Odessa's mouth moves, very slightly.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
The Donohues have owned this city
for forty years because they
bought it when nobody else wanted
it. They've been sitting on it
ever since. They don't sell. They
don't flip. They don't move fast.
(beat)
We do.

DESMOND
(mildly)
And who's going to find us two
billion dollars' worth of dirt in
a city where every broker who
matters has had lunch with Victor
Donohue once a month since 1970?

ESTHER
(beat)
Nobody who matters.

She clicks. The next slide is a single name.

"EXCLUSIVE BUYER'S REPRESENTATIVE, ATLANTA: HARMONY
DIVINE, KEEL & ASSOCIATES REALTY."

Silence.

LUKE
(genuinely confused)
Who?

ESTHER
Harmony Divine. Twenty-two.
Licensed in Georgia since 2003.
Closed nineteen residential
transactions in 2004 in
Lindbergh, Grant Park, and East
Point.

LUKE

(a disbelieving laugh)
Condos. You want to hand two billion dollars to a condo agent from Lindbergh.

ESTHER

I want to hand two billion dollars to a broker who has never had lunch with Victor Donohue.

(beat)

Every other broker in this city will call the Donohues the minute we make an offer. She won't. Because they've never picked up the phone for her.

DELPHINE

(examining her nails)
She's your roommate.

ESTHER

She was my roommate. Freshman year. Northwestern.

DELPHINE

She's your best friend.

ESTHER

She's the most honest person I know. That's not a conflict of interest, Delphine. In this family, it's a competitive advantage.

A faint snort from Odessa. Lucius doesn't smile, but his eyes do.

LUKE

(standing)

This is insane. Father. This is exactly what I said in Chicago. She's twenty-two. She's making it up as she goes, and now she's hiring her friends.

ESTHER

You're twenty-eight, Luke. And you put eighty million dollars of the family's money into Gideon's hedge fund.

LUKE
(flushing)
Ashe Capital is—

DELPHINE
(sharply)
Leave my husband out of it.

ESTHER
(evenly)
Ashe Capital is down thirty-one
percent since June.

The outside directors study their water glasses.

LUKE
(to the table)
I move that the Class A holders
vote. Right now. If my sister
wants to gamble two billion
dollars on a girl who sells
condos, then the family should
put its name on it.

LUCIUS
(quietly)
Sit down, Luke.

LUKE
I'd like a vote, Father.

A long beat. Lucius looks at his eldest son.

LUCIUS
Then you'll have one.
(to the Secretary)
Class A. By hand.

The CORPORATE SECRETARY looks up from the laptop.

CORPORATE SECRETARY
Present: Mr. Lucius Smilley,
thirty-four votes. Madame Odessa
Smilley, twenty. Mr. Desmond
Smilley, sixteen. Ms. Esther
Smilley, twelve. Mr. Luke
Smilley, six. Mrs. Delphine
Smilley-Ashe, six. Mrs. Vivienne
Smilley, four.
(beat)
Mr. Quentin Smilley, two votes.
Absent.

DELPHINE

(dry)

Asleep.

CORPORATE SECRETARY

On the motion to approve Ms.
Divine as exclusive buyer's
representative. Those in favor.

Esther raises her hand.

Vivienne raises her left hand. Her right stays under the table.

Lucius begins to raise his right hand. It trembles on the marble, a small, terrible flutter.

Under the table, Vivienne's fingers close around his left hand and squeeze.

Lucius stops. Slowly, calmly, he lets his right hand rest on the table. He raises his left.

Odessa sees it. Her eyes go from Lucius's shaking right hand to Vivienne's face and back. Nobody else notices.

CORPORATE SECRETARY (CONT'D)

Mr. Lucius Smilley, Mrs. Smilley,
Ms. Esther Smilley. Fifty votes
in favor.

(beat)

Opposed.

Luke raises his hand. Delphine raises hers, without looking up from her nails.

CORPORATE SECRETARY (CONT'D)

Twelve opposed. Mr. Desmond
Smilley?

DESMOND

(pleasantly, hands
folded)

I abstain.

LUKE

(turning on him)

Uncle Desmond.

DESMOND

It's a real-estate decision,
nephew.

(the tiniest pause on
"nephew")
I'm in finance.

CORPORATE SECRETARY
Madame Smilley?

Every head turns to Odessa. Fifty yes. Twelve no. Sixteen abstaining. Twenty votes on the table, and a majority needs fifty-one.

Odessa takes her time. She looks at Luke. She looks at Esther. She looks across Peachtree Road at the Donohue crown.

ODESSA
In 1952, a broker in Savannah
told me that nobody who mattered
would sell to a colored family on
the waterfront.
(beat)
So we found a broker who didn't
matter.

She raises her hand.

ODESSA (CONT'D)
Seventy.

LUKE
(to the ceiling)
Over my dead body.

LUCIUS
(evenly, not looking at
him)
Then we'll miss you.

A beat. Somebody at the far end of the table coughs to cover a laugh.

LUCIUS (CONT'D)
The motion carries. Esther.

ESTHER
(to the Secretary)
Please ask Ms. Divine to come in.

The Secretary goes to the door. Luke sits down hard. Delphine finally looks up from her nails at Esther. Pure hatred, beautifully made up.

Desmond watches his brother's right hand resting on the marble. He watches it for a long time.

The door opens. Harmony walks in, in the navy St. John, a leather folio under her arm.

The whole family council looks at her. She looks back.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Harmony Divine. Smilley
International's exclusive buyer's
representative for the City of
Atlanta.

(beat)

One and a half percent on every
closed acquisition. On two
billion dollars.

HARMONY

(barely)

That's thirty million dollars.

ESTHER

Before your broker's split.

(beat, smiling)

You work for me now.

CUT TO:

5 INT. SMILLEY TOWER – PRIVATE ELEVATOR – CONTINUOUS

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 9:48 AM EST

A gold-mirrored elevator. The doors close on Esther and Harmony.

For three floors, neither of them moves.

Then Harmony grabs the brass handrail with both hands and SCREAMS silently, her mouth wide open, her whole body shaking.

Esther watches her in the mirrored walls, grinning.

HARMONY

(a strangled whisper)

Thirty. MILLION.

ESTHER

Gross.

HARMONY

Gross!

ESTHER
Keel takes half.

HARMONY
Fifteen MILLION.

ESTHER
Before taxes.

HARMONY
(sliding down the wall
until she's sitting on
the floor of the
elevator in a
four-thousand-dollar
suit)
I have eleven dollars in my
checking account.

ESTHER
(dryly)
You'll need a better bank.

Harmony laughs. It turns into something else. She puts her
face in her hands.

Esther crouches beside her in her gray suit.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
(gently)
Hey. Hey.

HARMONY
(through her hands)
Why me?

ESTHER
I told them why.

HARMONY
You told them I'm honest. Esther,
you could've hired anybody. CB
Richard Ellis. Cushman. Some old
white man with a yacht.

ESTHER
(beat)
Because you're the only person in
Atlanta who's never lied to me.

Harmony lowers her hands. She looks at her best friend.

HARMONY
(quietly)
And you've never lied to me.

A beat. Esther's smile doesn't move. It doesn't have to. She's been holding it in place for three years.

ESTHER
(standing, offering her
hand)
Get up. You're wrinkling the suit
I paid for.

Harmony takes her hand and lets Esther pull her up. The elevator dings.

The doors open onto the gold lobby. Harmony takes a breath and straightens her jacket.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
(under her breath)
Look like you've already been
paid.

HARMONY
(under her breath)
I have been paid.

ESTHER
Not yet. Tomorrow at nine, we're
looking at land on Auburn Avenue.

HARMONY
(beat, stopping)
Auburn Avenue?

ESTHER
(walking out)
Keep up.

CUT TO:

**6 INT. DONOHUE TOWER — NATASHA'S OFFICE — 87TH FLOOR —
DAY**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 10:34 AM EST

Natasha's corner office, one floor below her father's: white and gold, orchids, a Romare Bearden collage on the wall, and a Bloomberg terminal on the desk.

Natasha sits behind the desk in a crimson suit reading a single sheet of printout. Her face is perfectly composed.

The door opens. Victor walks in without knocking, as he has every day since 1996.

VICTOR

Your assistant looks like she saw
a ghost.

NATASHA

She read the wire.
(holding out the sheet)
Dow Jones, ten-oh-two.

Victor takes it. He puts on his reading glasses.

INSERT — THE WIRE: "SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL NAMES EXCLUSIVE
ATLANTA BUYER'S BROKER FOR \$2 BILLION REAL ESTATE
PROGRAM... HARMONY DIVINE, 22, OF KEEL & ASSOCIATES
REALTY..."

VICTOR

(reading)
Two billion.

NATASHA

Downtown, Midtown, Buckhead. And
the Beltline, which the city
hasn't approved yet.

VICTOR

(beat)
Who is Harmony Divine?

NATASHA

(evenly)
The Smilleys just hired Lyric's
mother.

Victor lowers the paper and takes off his glasses.

VICTOR

Lyric.

NATASHA

Amond Baker's daughter. Marc's
goddaughter. The one he gave the
pony to.

(beat)

Harmony Divine sells condos in
Lindbergh, Daddy. As of this
morning she's holding a
two-billion-dollar checkbook with
a Smilley signature on it.

The door opens again. MARTIN OLSON (23), immaculate in a charcoal three-piece, walks in holding the same printout.

MARTIN
Grandfather. Aunt Natasha. I
assume you've seen—

NATASHA
We've seen.

MARTIN
(sitting on the arm of
a chair)
The Smilleys are buying Atlanta
one broker at a time.
(beat)
And they picked Amond Baker's
co-parent. Marc's right hand's
child's mother.
(beat)
That's not a coincidence. That's
a door.

VICTOR
(sharply)
Into what?

MARTIN
Into Marc. Into BSI. Into us.

Natasha presses the intercom.

NATASHA
Get me Marc.

NATASHA'S ASSISTANT (V.O.)
He's on line two, Mrs. Bullock.
He was already calling.

Natasha presses a button. The speakerphone crackles.

MARC (V.O.)
(filtered, cheerful)
Before anybody says anything.
She's good at her job.

NATASHA
Good morning, baby.

MARC (V.O.)
Morning, Mama. Morning,
Granddaddy. Morning, Martin, I
can hear you breathing.

MARTIN
(smiling thinly)
Cousin.

VICTOR
Marc-Anthony. Did you know about
this?

MARC (V.O.)
No, sir. I found out the same way
you did.

NATASHA
The Smilleys just gave your
goddaughter's mother two billion
dollars to buy our city out from
under us.

MARC (V.O.)
They gave her a retainer, Mama.
She still has to find the dirt.
(beat)
And Harmony Divine doesn't know a
thing about BSI, Blackwater, or
this family, except that I'm the
man who spoils her kid. There's
no door.

MARTIN
Everybody's a door, cousin.

MARC (V.O.)
(pleasantly)
Then stay out of the hallway,
Martin.

Victor almost smiles. Natasha doesn't.

NATASHA
Marc. Esther Smilley is her best
friend.

A pause on the line. A real one.

MARC (V.O.)
(beat)
What?

NATASHA
College roommates. Northwestern.
The Sentinel's society desk
called my office for comment.

Another pause.

MARC (V.O.)
(carefully)
I didn't know that.

MARTIN
(watching the phone)
Interesting.

MARC (V.O.)
(recovering, light)
Well. Now we know why the Smilley
girl keeps coming to our gate.
She's looking for the pony.
(beat)
I've got to go. Mama, don't buy
anything today.

NATASHA
I'm not buying anything.

MARC (V.O.)
You're thinking about it. I can
hear it.

The line clicks off. Natasha looks at her father.

NATASHA
He didn't know.

VICTOR
(putting his glasses
back in his pocket)
No. He didn't.
(beat, to Martin)
Martin. Give us the room.

MARTIN
(rising, gracious)
Of course.

He goes. At the door, he glances back at his grandfather.
Victor's face gives him nothing.

The door closes. Natasha waits.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
(quietly)
Someone used my office to request
the Harbour Point file in
October.

NATASHA

(beat)

Harbour Point. The customs broker
in Garden City?

VICTOR

On my letterhead. With my stamp.

NATASHA

Who?

VICTOR

I'll know by Friday.

(beat)

Until then, nobody else on these
two floors hears that name. Not
your husband. Not your nephew.

NATASHA

(beat)

Martin?

VICTOR

Nobody.

Natasha looks at the closed door. Then at her father.

NATASHA

Daddy. What's going on in this
building?

VICTOR

(going to the door)

The same thing that's going on
across the street, Natasha.

(beat)

Somebody's making moves.

He goes. Natasha sits alone with the wire.

FADE OUT.

ACT TWO**7 INT. KEEL & ASSOCIATES REALTY – BUCKHEAD – THE BULLPEN
– DAY**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 11:22 AM EST

The beige office. Forty cubicles. Phones ringing. Ordinarily.

Right now, nobody's on the phone. Every agent in the bullpen is standing up in a cubicle, looking at the front door.

Harmony walks in in the navy St. John.

The room goes silent. A phone rings somewhere. Nobody answers it.

MISTY CALLOWAY (30s), a blonde agent with a spray tan and an Escada blazer, leans over her cubicle wall.

MISTY

(sweetly)

Harmony! Oh my God! We saw it on the Dow Jones! Is it true?

HARMONY

(walking, not stopping)

Morning, Misty.

MISTY

(following her)

Two BILLION? With the SMILLEYS?
Girl, I have been trying to get a meeting with Smilley International since Christmas! How did you—

HARMONY

I went to college.

The office door at the end of the bullpen flies open. DONNA KEEL (50s), in a red suit, comes out with her arms wide open and a smile like a car salesman.

DONNA

THERE she is! There's my girl!

She wraps Harmony in a hug. Harmony stands stiffly inside it.

DONNA (CONT'D)
(pulling back, holding
her shoulders)
Sweetheart. I've been saying
since the day I hired you: that
girl's got something.

HARMONY
Yesterday you said "thinking"
isn't a closing.

DONNA
(laughing too loud)
And today you closed! Oh, come
on. Come on.
(gesturing grandly
toward a glass-walled
corner office)
It's yours. The corner office.
Phil's moving to the cubicle.
Isn't that right, Phil?

In the corner office, PHIL (60s), an old realtor, looks up
from a box he's already packing, unhappy.

HARMONY
(beat)
No, thank you.

DONNA
(beat)
I'm sorry?

HARMONY
I like my desk.

DONNA
Sweetheart. Your desk is next to
the bathroom.

HARMONY
I know where my desk is, Donna.
I've been sitting at it for two
years.
(beat)
Phil, keep your office.

PHIL
(sagging with relief)
God bless you.

Harmony walks past all of them to the cubicle by the
restroom door, under the loud air vent. She sits down. She

sets her leather folio on the desk next to Lyric's giraffe drawing and the FIND DEE flyer.

Donna follows her, recalculating.

DONNA

(lower)

Okay. Okay. Keep the desk. But we should talk about the split.

HARMONY

Fifty-fifty. It's in my contract.

DONNA

It is. It is. I was only thinking, with a deal this size, we'd want to bring in some senior support—

HARMONY

(looking up)

Esther Smilley hired me, Donna. Not the firm. She said so in writing. If anybody at Keel touches one of her deals without my name on it, the retainer's void.

(beat)

That's in her contract.

Donna's smile freezes. It stays frozen for a long second.

DONNA

(brightly)

Well! Aren't we lucky to have you.

She goes. The bullpen slowly exhales and pretends to go back to work.

Misty lingers at the cubicle wall.

MISTY

(sweetly)

You know, if you ever need someone to help with showings—

HARMONY

Misty. Last Christmas you asked me if I was "the new receptionist."

MISTY
(beat)
Did I?

HARMONY
Twice.

Misty disappears.

Harmony sits alone at her little desk under the air vent.
She looks at the flyer. Dee grins back at her.

HARMONY (CONT'D)
(whispering)
You'd have laughed so hard.

She picks up the phone and dials.

HARMONY (CONT'D)
(into phone)
Mama. It's me. Sit down.

CUT TO:

8 INT. SMILLEY TOWER — 70TH FLOOR — LUKE'S OFFICE — DAY
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 11:51 AM EST

A big, dark, masculine office. Chicago Bulls memorabilia.
A framed photo of Luke shaking Michael Jordan's hand. A
putting green on the carpet.

Luke paces with a golf club in his hand like he'd like to
hit somebody with it. Delphine sits on his desk, legs
crossed, scrolling through a BlackBerry.

LUKE
A condo agent. A condo agent from
LINDBERGH.

DELPHINE
You've said "Lindbergh" nine
times. I'm starting to think you
have a problem with Lindbergh.

LUKE
I have a problem with Grandmother
raising her hand for a girl who's
never closed a deal over four
hundred thousand dollars!

DELPHINE

Grandmother raises her hand for whoever makes you angriest. It's her favorite hobby.

LUKE

(swinging at nothing)
And Uncle Desmond. "I abstain."
He's been telling me for a year that Esther's going to run this company into the ground, and when it counts, he folds his hands and says he's in FINANCE.

DELPHINE

Uncle Desmond doesn't lose votes. He waits for other people to lose them for him.

(not looking up)

Did you see Father's hand?

Luke stops pacing.

LUKE

What about his hand?

DELPHINE

(beat)

Nothing. He voted left-handed.

LUKE

So?

DELPHINE

Father's been right-handed my whole life.

Luke stares at her. She finally looks up from the BlackBerry.

DELPHINE (CONT'D)

Never mind. I have something better.

LUKE

Better than two billion dollars going to Esther's roommate?

DELPHINE

Better than money. I have Donohues.

(holding up the
BlackBerry)

Mother asked me Friday to find out who in the Donohue family is making beauty products. My buyer in Ghana got a call from the shea cooperative in Kumasi. An American girl called three times last week asking about "Toussaint shea."

LUKE

So?

DELPHINE

So I asked the co-op for the number she called from. They keep a log. Rural Ghana. International calls are expensive, so they write them all down.

(reading)

A 404 number. Atlanta. I had Crowe's people run it.

(beat)

It's the main line of the Olson Estate on Paces Ferry.

LUKE

(beat)

The Olsons. The Congresswoman.

DELPHINE

And the Congresswoman's daughter, Mallory, who runs her daddy's plastic-surgery practice and has a black AmEx. And her best friend, who spends every afternoon at that house because her own mother is too busy running Donohue Global Holdings.

(beat)

Grace Bullock.

LUKE

The singer?

DELPHINE

The singer. Platinum in six weeks. Every Black girl in America between twelve and twenty-five wants to smell like Grace Bullock.

(beat)

And they're making a beauty line out of Simone Donohue's

grandmother's recipes in a kitchen in Buckhead.

LUKE

How do you know that?

DELPHINE

Because Mother told me that in 1976 she offered Simone Donohue two million dollars for a green notebook, and Simone Donohue sent her back a jar of rose balm.

(beat)

And now two little girls are calling Ghana asking for Toussaint shea.

Luke sets the golf club down on the desk. He's starting to smile.

LUKE

If Grace Bullock launches a beauty line, it'll kill Smile.

DELPHINE

If Grace Bullock launches a beauty line, it'll kill Smile's entire youth market for ten years.

(beat)

Unless we find out what's in the notebook first.

LUKE

Mother will want to know.

DELPHINE

(sliding off the desk)

Mother will want to know first. Uncle Desmond will want to know second.

(at the door)

And Esther won't know at all.

LUKE

Why not?

DELPHINE

(smiling)

Because Esther's busy. She's buying Atlanta.

She goes. Luke picks up his putter. He lines up a putt on the carpet and sinks it.

LUKE
(to himself)
Lindbergh.

CUT TO:

9 INT. BSI TOWER – 57TH FLOOR – "THE GHOST ROOM" – DAY
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 12:36 PM EST

A windowless room one floor below Marc's office. Blue light, server racks humming behind glass, and six flat-panel monitors on a curved desk. Cold enough to see your breath, almost. A mini-fridge full of Red Bull.

KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25), in a black hoodie, sits cross-legged in an ergonomic chair with a keyboard in her lap. TOBIAS OKAFOR (24), in shirtsleeves and a bow tie, stands behind her with a stack of photocopies.

Marc leans on the doorframe. Amond sits on a stool with his arms crossed, glaring at nothing.

KEISHA
India's clear. Both shops. One of them makes temple ornaments, the other one only cuts marble for hotel lobbies in Dubai.
(beat)
Three left. Hong Kong. Israel. South Africa.

MARC
How long?

KEISHA
Hong Kong's a front for a triad jewelry shop, so that's either tomorrow or never. Israel's a family business, very religious, closed Saturdays, doesn't answer email. South Africa—
(beat)
South Africa's interesting. Their website went down on January fourth.

MARC
The day after Lamar.

KEISHA

The day after Lamar.

Marc turns to Tobias.

MARC

Harbour Point.

TOBIAS

(holding up the
photocopies)

I've got six years of their
account at Chatham. Most of it's
boring. Customs bonds, duties,
port fees, payroll for eleven
people.

(beat)

Then, in October, somebody filed
a new designation letter with the
bank. Adding an authorized agent
for cash transactions.

He hands Marc a single page. Marc reads it.

INSERT – THE COPY: A letter on heavy DGH letterhead. At
the top, engraved: "DONOHUE GLOBAL HOLDINGS – OFFICE OF
THE CHAIRMAN." A single typed paragraph authorizing "the
bearer of this letter" to "transact on behalf of Harbour
Point Logistics, LLC." At the bottom, not a signature. A
red rubber stamp: "V. DONOHUE – CHAIRMAN."

BACK TO SCENE

Marc looks at it for a very long time.

AMOND

(standing, reading over
his shoulder)

Your grandfather's office.

MARC

(quietly)

It's a stamp.

TOBIAS

It's a stamp. Every big office
has one. For routine
correspondence.

MARC

My grandfather signs his own
name. Every time. Even on
Christmas cards.

(beat)
He says a stamp is how a man lies
about being busy.

KEISHA
So either somebody lied about
your grandfather being busy—

MARC
—or somebody used his office
without him.

A silence.

AMOND
(carefully)
Marc. You were in the library
with him last night. Did he look
like a man who knew about this?

MARC
(beat)
He looked like a man who'd never
heard of it before.
(beat)
And then he called his lawyer at
ten-thirty at night.

TOBIAS
"The bearer of this letter."
Anybody who walked into Chatham
with that piece of paper could
withdraw cash. No name, no ID
beyond a driver's license. They'd
have to photocopy it.

MARC
Then they have a photocopy.

TOBIAS
Chatham's a hundred-year-old
bank. They'll have it on
microfiche in a basement.

MARC
Get it.

TOBIAS
Legally?

MARC
(beat)
Get it gently.

Tobias nods. Marc folds the copy in half and puts it in his inside pocket.

MARC (CONT'D)
Nobody. Not the General. Not my mother. Especially not my grandfather.

KEISHA
You think he—

MARC
I think somebody wants it to look like he did. That's worse.

A beat. Amond is still standing, arms still folded.

MARC (CONT'D)
(to Amond)
Say it.

AMOND
Say what?

MARC
You've been glaring at the server rack for ten minutes. Say it.

AMOND
(beat)
Harmony works for the Smilleys now.

MARC
Harmony works for Harmony.

AMOND
She works for Esther Smilley. Her best friend. Which, apparently, nobody in this building knew.
(beat)
Lyric's going to be at Ravenhurst, Marc. On weekends. Playing with the Smilley babies. Around Smilley security, Smilley lawyers, Smilley everything.

MARC
Lyric's been around the Smilleys since before she could walk, Mond. We just didn't know it.

AMOND
That's supposed to make me feel
better?

MARC
(beat)
No.

Amond looks at him. Marc looks back. The thing from last
night at the Table is still sitting between them.

AMOND
(quietly)
You didn't know about Esther and
Harmony.

MARC
I didn't know.

AMOND
Your mother had to tell you on
the speakerphone.

MARC
(beat)
Yeah.

AMOND
(almost gently)
You get a look, you know. When
somebody says her name. The
Smilley girl.

MARC
I don't get a look.

KEISHA
(not turning around
from the monitors)
You get a look.

TOBIAS
(studying his
photocopies)
You definitely get a look.

Marc looks at the three of them.

MARC
(dry)
South Africa. Chatham. Get out of
my face.

He goes. The door hisses shut. Keisha and Tobias exchange a glance.

KEISHA

(to Amond)

He froze her face on the gate camera. Did you know that? It's still on his laptop.

AMOND

(beat)

I know.

CUT TO:

10 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – DAY

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 1:44 PM EST

The DA's office. Dee's photograph grins from the corkboard at eye level from Arianna's chair.

A large survey map of Northside Drive NW, West Paces Ferry to Moores Mill, has been unrolled across the conference table and weighed down with legal pads and Carla's steel thermos.

Carla stands over it with a red marker. Arianna stands on the other side of the table in shirtsleeves.

CARLA

Forty-one houses on this stretch.
I've got nineteen letters back already. Rich folks answer fast when the DA's name is on the envelope. They want you to know they're law-abiding.

(tapping houses with the marker, one by one)

Seven parties that night that I can confirm. Six with caterers. Four with valet. Two with off-duty police working the door.

ARIANNA

Off-duty APD?

CARLA

Zone Two. Nineteen-dollar-an-hour details. That's the best news I've had all week. Cops write things down.

(beat)
And this.

She pulls a yellowed newspaper clipping from a plastic sleeve and lays it on the map. The Atlanta Sentinel, Living section, Thursday, January 3, 2002. BEHIND THE GATES, by Bernadette Sinclair: "RINGING IN 2002 ON NORTHSIDE: THE PARTIES, THE PEOPLE, THE PEARLS."

ARIANNA
(very still)
Bernadette Sinclair.

CARLA
God bless that woman. She's the best witness in Georgia. She never saw a thing in her life she didn't put in a column.
(reading, pleased)
"...the Hendersons' black-tie extravaganza at 3244 Northside, where two hundred guests rang in the new year to a sixteen-piece orchestra..."
(beat)
Two hundred people. Premier Valet. Two off-duty officers on the door.
(beat)
Three hundred yards from where Dee Divine walked out of Lamont Grier's house.

She draws a red circle on the map. Not around the Hendersons'. Around the Griers'.

CARLA (CONT'D)
I start at the Griers'. I walk the route. Every house between the Griers' and wherever a young man with no car would've been going. Moores Mill. MARTA at Lindbergh. His mama's house on Campbellton Road. I talk to every valet, every bartender, every nanny, every cop.

ARIANNA
(evenly)
That's months.

CARLA

It's three years late. Months is fast.

Arianna's eyes drift, unwillingly, to the clipping. Below the column text there's a grainy black-and-white photo spread. Party guests in tuxedos and gowns. Captions in tiny type.

She can't read the captions from where she's standing.

She doesn't lean closer.

CARLA (CONT'D)

(capping the marker)

Madam District Attorney, can I say something that isn't my business?

ARIANNA

(beat)

Go ahead.

CARLA

You look like you haven't slept since Thursday.

ARIANNA

(a practiced smile)

I'm the DA, Carla. Nobody in this building has slept since Thursday.

CARLA

(beat, kindly)

My first year at the GBI, I worked a case where a little boy drowned in a neighbor's pool in Marietta. Three years old. I didn't sleep for a month. My husband thought I was having an affair.

(beat)

Some cases get in your bones. This one's already in yours. I can see it.

Arianna holds the smile. Barely.

ARIANNA

Harmony Divine thanked me on the internet.

CARLA

I read it.

ARIANNA

She's twenty-two. Like me. She wrote, "For the first time in three years, I believe somebody."
(beat)

I just want to deserve it.

Carla studies her for a long moment. Then she rolls up the map, clipping and all, and tucks it under her arm.

CARLA

Then let me do my job. And you go home and sleep.

She picks up her thermos. At the door she turns back.

CARLA (CONT'D)

And Madam District Attorney?

ARIANNA

Yes?

CARLA

I'm going to need to talk to everybody at every one of those seven parties who's still in Georgia.

(beat)

That'll include some people you know. Neighbors. Your parents' friends. It might include your parents.

ARIANNA

(beat)

I understand.

CARLA

I just didn't want you to be surprised.

She goes. Arianna stands alone at the empty conference table.

On the corkboard, Dee grins.

She sits down in her chair. She opens her bottom desk drawer. She takes out a small bottle of Advil, shakes out three, and swallows them dry.

She doesn't look at the photograph. She looks at the door
Carla left through.

FADE OUT.

ACT THREE**11 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S OFFICE – DAY**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 2:21 PM EST

Elxa's converted-storeroom office. A new addition: a small whiteboard behind her desk, turned to face the wall.

Elxa sits behind the desk in uniform. DEPUTY CHIEF WARREN HUGHES (46), tall, broad, silver at the temples, in full uniform with a chest full of ribbons, stands in front of it. He hasn't been offered a chair and doesn't take one.

HUGHES

Budget hearing's at nine tomorrow, Chief. All four deputy chiefs testify, then Q-and-A with the full Council. We won't get out before two.

ELXA

Then we'll do it Thursday. Nine o'clock. My conference room.

HUGHES

(beat)

Appreciate the flexibility, Chief.

ELXA

I appreciate the heads-up, Warren.

He doesn't like that she calls him Warren. He covers it.

HUGHES

Command-staff meeting on the Blackwater investigation. Everybody at the table?

ELXA

All four deputy chiefs, the task force commander, and me.

HUGHES

Not the Feds?

ELXA

Not the Feds.

HUGHES
(a small smile)
Good. They leak.

Elxa doesn't blink.

ELXA
(pleasantly)
Everybody leaks, Warren. That's
why I'm keeping the table small.

HUGHES
(beat)
Of course.

He turns to go. Then he stops. He can't help himself.

HUGHES (CONT'D)
How's your grandfather?

ELXA
(beat)
Excuse me?

HUGHES
Just making conversation, Chief.
The whole building's been reading
about it. Night six in the
library, I hear.
(beat)
Hell of a thing. Man calls the
mayor to get his granddaughter a
job, and his wife locks him out
of the bedroom.

The air in the room drops ten degrees.

ELXA
(evenly)
My grandmother has been married
to my grandfather for forty-five
years, Deputy Chief. She's locked
him out of the bedroom before.
She's never once locked him out
of the family.
(beat)
And the Mayor appointed me
because I caught the Peachtree
Strangler when your whole
division swore it was three
different men.

HUGHES
(stiffening)
That was a task-force effort,
Chief.

ELXA
It was. I led it.

A long, cold silence.

HUGHES
(finally)
Thursday. Nine o'clock.

ELXA
Thursday. Nine o'clock.

He walks out. The door closes.

Elxa sits very still. Then she reaches behind her and turns the little whiteboard around.

INSERT – THE WHITEBOARD, in Elxa's handwriting:

"TOLBERT – 2nd phone

KEMP – partial print

WASHINGTON – red car

ALBRIGHT – wife's PI

HUGHES – 'Chief believes coin was FAKE''

She looks at the last line. She uncaps a marker and underlines HUGHES twice.

JEREMY (O.S.)
He called you "Chief" nine times.

Jeremy stands in the doorway with two cups of coffee. He's been there a while.

ELXA
I counted eleven.

JEREMY
(handing her a coffee)
That's how you know he hates you.

ELXA
(taking it)

He hated me before he met me.
That's how I know it's personal.
(beat)
Go see your father.

JEREMY
(beat)
Now?

ELXA
Your father trained Hughes. Your
father made him a deputy chief.
Your father closed the Harlow
case and won't tell us who told
him to.
(beat)
Go ask him what kind of man
Warren Hughes is when nobody's
looking.

JEREMY
(quietly)
Elx. He's my dad.

ELXA
I know. That's why he'll tell
you.

CUT TO:

**12 INT. THE JACKSON HOME – CASCADE HEIGHTS – THE BACK
PORCH – DAY**
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 3:08 PM EST

A deep screened back porch on a big brick house in Cascade Heights. Wind chimes. A space heater glowing. A card table with a half-finished jigsaw puzzle: the Atlanta skyline at night.

FORMER CHIEF HAROLD JACKSON (57), retired three weeks, in a cardigan and reading glasses, fits a piece of sky into the puzzle. He looks like a man who doesn't know what to do with his hands.

Jeremy sits across from him in his task-force windbreaker.

HAROLD
Your mother's got me doing
puzzles. Five thousand pieces.
She says it's good for the mind.
I think she's trying to keep me
off the phone.

JEREMY
Are you calling people?

HAROLD
(beat)
I call people.

JEREMY
Who?

HAROLD
People who used to call me.
(fitting a piece)
Thirty-one years, son. Phone rang
every night. Now it rings when
your mother's sister wants to
talk about her gallbladder.

Jeremy watches him work the puzzle.

JEREMY
Warren Hughes.

Harold's hand stops over the table.

HAROLD
What about him?

JEREMY
Tell me about him.

HAROLD
(setting down the
piece)
Warren Hughes walked into the
academy in 1979 with a Fort
Valley State degree, his
granddaddy's badge, and a chip on
his shoulder the size of Stone
Mountain. Best patrolman I ever
trained. Brave. Smart. Honest.
(beat)
I made him a sergeant in '85, a
lieutenant in '90, and a deputy
chief in '99. For six years,
everybody in that building knew
he was going to be Chief when I
retired.
(beat)
Everybody but the Mayor.

JEREMY
And Victor Donohue.

HAROLD
(sharply)
Don't.

JEREMY
Dad.

HAROLD
You married into that family,
Jeremy. That's your business, and
I love your wife like she was my
own. But don't sit on my porch
and tell me what Victor Donohue
did. I've known what Victor
Donohue does since before you
were born.

A tense beat. The wind chimes ring.

JEREMY
(quietly)
Hughes is leaking, Dad.

Harold closes his eyes.

JEREMY (CONT'D)
To WBKG. From his personal cell.
The coin on day one. The funeral
on Saturday. And somebody faxed
Elxa's command-staff report to
the FBI from a Kinko's on Ponce.

HAROLD
(eyes still closed)
You can prove that?

JEREMY
Thursday we'll prove it.

A long silence. Harold opens his eyes. He looks older than
he did a minute ago.

HAROLD
Warren came to see me the night
the Mayor announced your wife.
December ninth. Sat right where
you're sitting. Drank half a
bottle of my scotch. He cried,
son. I've seen that man walk into
a burning apartment on Hollywood
Road for a baby, and I'd never
seen him cry.
(beat)

He said, "Twenty-five years,
Harold. Twenty-five years, and
they gave it to a girl because of
her last name."

JEREMY
She earned it.

HAROLD
I know she earned it. So does he.
That's what's killing him.
(beat)
Hurt men leak, Jeremy. They don't
do it for money. They do it so
somebody somewhere knows they
still matter.

JEREMY
(beat)
Is that an excuse?

HAROLD
No. It's a diagnosis.
(picking the puzzle
piece back up)
Tell your wife this, from me. If
it's Warren, don't humiliate him.
Don't walk him out in front of
the cameras. Take his badge in a
room with the door closed and let
him keep his pension.
(beat)
He earned that too.

Jeremy nods slowly. He stands.

JEREMY
Dad. The Harlow case. In 2000.

Harold's hand freezes over the puzzle.

JEREMY (CONT'D)
Who told you to close it?

A very long beat. Harold fits the piece into the sky. It's
the wrong piece. He leaves it there.

HAROLD
(quietly)
Go home, son. Kiss your wife.

Jeremy looks at him. Then he goes.

Harold sits alone on the porch. He looks at the wrong piece in the puzzle sky.

He doesn't take it out.

CUT TO:

13 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR – DAY
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 3:52 PM EST

Afternoon tea. The pale-yellow parlor, gold light slanting through wavy glass. A silver tea service, cucumber sandwiches, and a plate of lemon squares.

Simone sits in her wingback chair. JOAN DONOHUE (66), elegant in a camel pantsuit with the Washington pearls at her throat, sits across from her, pouring.

JOAN

Night six.

SIMONE

I know what night it is. I have a list.

JOAN

(handing her a cup)

He'll make seven.

SIMONE

Of course he'll make seven. He's the most stubborn man I ever gave birth to.

JOAN

Theodore might disagree.

SIMONE

Theodore is stubborn about money. Victor is stubborn about love. Only one of those makes a man sleep on a sofa.

(sipping)

In 1974 he was back on the fourth night with Zora Neale Hurston. This time he's reading Tolstoy and eating cobbler from the West End.

JOAN

(beat)

Cobbler?

SIMONE

Marc took it to him last night.
Peach. From Dolores Whitfield's.

JOAN

(setting down the pot,
a flicker of a smile)
That boy.

SIMONE

That boy is the only one in this
family who remembers that Victor
likes things that aren't
expensive.

Joan laughs softly. Then she sobers.

JOAN

Mother Simone. The Smilleys hired
Harmony Divine this morning.

SIMONE

I heard. Two billion dollars.

JOAN

Natasha's beside herself. Martin
says it's a door into the family.

SIMONE

(dismissively)
Martin thinks everything's a
door. That's because he's always
looking for a way in.

Joan looks up. Simone sips her tea serenely.

JOAN

(carefully)
You don't like Martin.

SIMONE

I love Martin. He's my
great-grandson. I held him at his
christening, and he didn't cry
once. Not once, Joan. Not when
the water hit him, not when the
Bishop said his name.

(beat)

A baby should cry at a
christening.

Joan doesn't answer that.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

(briskly)

As for the Divine girl. She'll do fine. She was raised by a nurse and a bus driver. Those people can smell a lie at forty paces.

(beat)

It's the Smilley girl I'm waiting on.

JOAN

Esther?

SIMONE

She'll write.

JOAN

Write what?

SIMONE

A thank-you note. For my invitation. She came to the gate twice and turned around twice. A girl raised by Odessa Smilley doesn't leave a debt on the table. She'll write.

JOAN

How do you know?

SIMONE

(beat, looking out the window toward Ravenhurst)

Because in 1952, I would have.

Joan watches her mother-in-law. Simone's face is serene, but her hand on the teacup is very still.

JOAN

(gently)

You've never told me what happened in Savannah.

SIMONE

I've never told anyone what happened in Savannah.

JOAN

Not even Victor?

SIMONE

(beat)

Especially not Victor.

She sets her cup down on its saucer without a sound.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Have a lemon square, Joan.
They're from the Manor. Winston's
new girl made them. They're too
sweet, and I've eaten four.

CUT TO:

14 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – MALLORY'S SITTING ROOM – DAY
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 4:33 PM EST

A pretty upstairs sitting room in the Olson Estate: pale green, a white desk under the window, a MacBook, stacks of invoices from Olson Facial & Aesthetic Surgery, and a Spelman Economics textbook.

Mallory sits at the desk in a cashmere sweater, working through the practice's payables with a calculator. The green leather Formulary sits beside her elbow.

A knock. Martin leans in the doorway, jacket off, in his waistcoat.

MARTIN

Knocking. As requested.

MALLORY

(not looking up)

Congratulations. You're a person.

He comes in and sits on the arm of the loveseat.

MARTIN

How's Daddy's empire?

MALLORY

Up forty percent in eighteen
months. His receptionist bills
Aetna for everything twice. I'm
firing her Friday.

MARTIN

(smiling)

Cold.

MALLORY

Efficient.

He looks around the room. His eyes land on the green book and stay there a half-second too long.

MARTIN

Is that it?

MALLORY

(beat)

Is what it?

MARTIN

The Toussaint Formulary.
Great-Grandmother's book.

(off her look)

Mal. I'm not stupid. You and Grace have been locked in the catering kitchen for a week. The whole house smells like roses.

MALLORY

It's a family recipe book.

MARTIN

It's the most valuable family recipe book in America.

(beat)

Vivienne Smilley offered Great-Grandmother two million dollars for it in 1976. You know what two million in 1976 is today?

MALLORY

Seven million, give or take.

MARTIN

(delighted)

You DO pay attention.

(beat, serious)

Mal. You can't leave it on your desk. You can't carry it around in your purse. The housekeepers come in here. The florist comes in here. Daddy's patients' drivers park in our motor court.

(beat)

Let me keep it in the safe in my office. Donohue Tower. Twenty-four-hour security. Nobody gets on the eighty-sixth floor without a badge.

MALLORY

(beat)

No.

MARTIN

Why not?

MALLORY

Because Grandma Simone gave it to me and Grace. Not the family. Not Donohue Tower. Us.

(beat)

And she said beat the Smilleys. She didn't say put it in a safe.

Martin holds up his hands, a peace offering.

MARTIN

Okay. Okay. I was trying to help.

MALLORY

I know.

He stands. At the door, he turns.

MARTIN

Velvet tomorrow night.

MALLORY

(sighing)

How do you know about Velvet?

MARTIN

I know everything that happens at Velvet. It's a Donohue club.

(beat)

Unofficially.

MALLORY

Grace is driving. We'll be home by midnight.

MARTIN

Be careful. There are people at Velvet who aren't what they look like.

MALLORY

Martin. You're describing every nightclub on earth.

MARTIN

(smiling)

Then be careful at every
nightclub on earth.

He goes. Mallory sits for a moment.

Then she picks up the Formulary, opens her desk drawer,
and takes out a small key. She crosses to a painting on
the wall, a Hudson River landscape, and swings it out on a
hinge. A small wall safe.

She puts the book inside. She closes it. She spins the
dial.

She swings the painting back. She stands looking at it.

MALLORY
(to herself)
"Martin's always weird."

She doesn't sound so sure anymore.

FADE OUT.

ACT FOUR**15 INT. RAVENHURST – THE MORNING ROOM – DUSK**

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 5:14 PM EST

A sunny French room at the back of the château, going gold at dusk. White sofas, a crystal chandelier, and a bottle of Krug in a silver bucket.

On the floor, on a quilt, three little girls: EMMA and VICTORIA SMILLEY (2), in matching velvet dresses, and LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2), in a purple sweater, with her giraffe. They're building a tower of blocks together. NANNY BEA watches from a chair.

Esther pops the cork. Harmony, still in the navy suit, shoes kicked off, holds out two glasses. Odessa sits in a bergère chair like a throne, her cane across her lap.

ESTHER

To Harmony Divine. Exclusive
buyer's representative of Smilley
International.

HARMONY

To Esther Smilley, who is insane.

ODESSA

(raising a small glass
of sherry)

To Lindbergh.

They laugh. They drink.

ODESSA (CONT'D)

(to Harmony)

Miss Divine. My grandson said
"Lindbergh" nine times after the
meeting. I had my secretary
count.

HARMONY

Is that bad?

ODESSA

It's wonderful. Luke only repeats
things when he's frightened.

(beat)

I read about your brother in
Saturday's paper.

The room quiets a little. Harmony sets down her glass.

HARMONY

Yes, ma'am.

ODESSA

Three years.

HARMONY

Three years Sunday before last.

ODESSA

(beat)

In 1961, in Chicago, a young man who drove for my husband went out one night for a pack of cigarettes and never came back. Nineteen years old. His mother came to our kitchen door every Sunday for two years.

(beat)

Cornelius hired four detectives. They found his car at the lakefront. Nothing else. Not ever.

Esther looks at her grandmother. She's never heard this.

HARMONY

(quietly)

I'm so sorry.

ODESSA

His mother never stopped. I watched her, and I learned something.

(beat)

Don't let anybody tell you when to stop looking, child. Not the police. Not the District Attorney. Not your mother. Not my granddaughter.

HARMONY

(beat)

Yes, ma'am.

ODESSA

And if they find him, whatever they find, you make whoever took him pay for it. In money or in blood. Your choice. But you make them pay.

Esther shifts uncomfortably. Harmony just nods, eyes shining.

On the quilt, the tower of blocks falls over with a crash. Lyric shrieks with laughter. Victoria laughs with her, big and loud, head thrown back.

LYRIC

Pony MARC!

ESTHER

(too quickly)

What did she say?

HARMONY

(laughing, wiping her eyes)

She says that about everything now. Her godfather gave her a pony for Christmas and named it after himself.

(beat)

Marc-Anthony Bullock. Amond's best friend.

Odessa's sherry glass pauses halfway to her mouth.

ODESSA

(beat)

Marc-Anthony Bullock is your daughter's godfather?

HARMONY

Since she was born. He's the only one of Amond's people I can stand. He comes to her birthday parties in a dinosaur costume.

VICTORIA

(looking up from the blocks, delighted)

FUNNY MAN!

Esther goes perfectly still.

Odessa looks at Victoria. Then at Esther. Then, very slowly, back at Victoria.

HARMONY

(oblivious, charmed)

Oh, she knows him? From TV?

BEA
(from her chair,
knitting, without
looking up)
The young lady has excellent
taste in comedians.

Esther drains her champagne in one swallow.

ESTHER
(bright, standing)
More Krug.

She goes to the silver bucket. Her back is to the room.
Her hand on the bottle is not steady.

Odessa watches her granddaughter's back. She takes a sip
of sherry.

ODESSA
(to no one, mildly)
What a small city this is turning
out to be.

CUT TO:

**16 INT. BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES, LLP – ROBERT'S OFFICE –
40TH FLOOR – DUSK**
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 5:41 PM EST

Robert's corner office: dark wood, law books, framed
photos of Natasha and the kids, a signed photograph of
Robert with Thurgood Marshall's widow, and a view of the
sunset over Midtown.

Robert sits behind the desk, tie loosened, signing
letters. The door opens and closes. Camille stands inside
it, back against the door.

She holds a small cream card between two fingers.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Camille, I've got the Hendricks
brief at six-

CAMILLE
She came to my office yesterday.

Robert looks up.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

While you were in the deposition.
She brought cheese straws. From
Henri's. She sat on my couch for
twelve minutes and talked about
perfume.

(beat)

And then she left this in the
box.

She walks to the desk and lays the card down in front of
him.

INSERT – THE CARD: "Enjoy them. You've already had
everything else of his."

Robert reads it. He reads it again. He puts down his pen.

ROBERT

(quietly)

She's guessing.

CAMILLE

(a harsh laugh)

"Everything else of his." Robert.
That's not a guess. That's an
invoice.

ROBERT

She smelled something on a shirt.
She doesn't know it was you.

CAMILLE

She said "collars," Robert. At my
door. She looked me in the face
and said "collars."

Robert stands. He goes to the window. He stands with his
back to her.

ROBERT

(low)

How did she smell it on the
shirt, Camille?

A beat.

CAMILLE

What?

ROBERT

The shirt was at your place for five days. You had five days. You have a dry cleaner in your building.

(turning)

How did Natasha smell your perfume on a shirt you had five days to wash?

Camille holds his eyes. She doesn't answer.

ROBERT (CONT'D)

(realizing)

You didn't wash it.

CAMILLE

(evenly)

I forgot.

ROBERT

You don't forget, Camille. You're the only lawyer in this building who's never forgotten a filing deadline in fourteen years.

CAMILLE

(beat)

Then maybe I was tired of being the only one of us who remembers everything.

The words sit there. Robert stares at her.

ROBERT

(quietly)

What do you want?

CAMILLE

(her voice finally cracking)

I wanted you to come to my door on a Saturday for me. Not for a shirt.

A long beat. Robert looks at her, and for a moment he looks like he might cross the room.

He doesn't.

ROBERT

(finally)

Stay away from her.

CAMILLE
She came to ME.

ROBERT
Then stay out of the room when
she does.

Camille picks the card up off the desk. She tucks it into
her jacket pocket.

CAMILLE
(very calm now)
I'm keeping this.

ROBERT
Why?

CAMILLE
(at the door)
Because it's the first thing your
wife has ever written to me.
(beat)
I'd like to be able to read it
again when I decide what to write
back.

She goes. The door closes.

Robert stands alone at the window. Below him, the city
lights come on, block by block.

He picks up the phone. He dials. It rings.

ROBERT (CONT'D)
(into phone, warm,
easy)
Tash. It's me. I'm leaving now.
You want me to pick up anything?
(beat)
No? Okay.
(beat)
I love you.

He listens. Whatever she says, he closes his eyes.

CUT TO:

17 INT. THE BAKER HOME — 214 MAGNOLIA TERRACE — KITCHEN
— EVENING

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 6:17 PM EST

The warm Baker kitchen in Belmont Crest's "doctors' row": copper pots, a big farmhouse table, Gloria's African violets on the windowsill. A pot of chili on the stove.

GLORIA BAKER (48), in a Delta Sigma Theta sweatshirt, stands at the counter with the evening Sentinel folded open to the business page. DR. CURTIS BAKER (50), still in his white coat from the hospital, sits at the table. KIARA BAKER (15), in a Belmont Crest Academy uniform, does geometry homework with earbuds in.

GLORIA

(reading)

"Smilley International names
Harmony Divine, 22, exclusive
buyer's representative for its
two-billion-dollar Atlanta
real-estate program."

(lowering the paper)

Two billion dollars, Curtis.

CURTIS

I heard you the first four times.

GLORIA

The girl who wouldn't take a
Tiffany bracelet from our son is
now working for the Smilleys.

KIARA

(pulling out one
earbud)

Is that the lady who slapped
Amond?

GLORIA AND CURTIS

(together)

How do you know about that?

KIARA

It's on CrestWatch. Everybody at
school read it in the library.

(beat)

She slapped him in front of a
Saks truck.

GLORIA

(to Curtis, horrified)

In front of a Saks truck.

CURTIS

Kiara. Earbud.

KIARA
(putting it back in)
I'm just saying. Respect.

Gloria sets the paper down. She sits across from her husband.

GLORIA
She'll have money now. Real money. She can hire a real lawyer.

CURTIS
She has a real lawyer.

GLORIA
She has a legal-aid lawyer who works out of a strip mall in East Point.
(beat)
Now she'll get somebody from King & Spalding, and they'll bury Stanley in motions until Lyric's in kindergarten.

CURTIS
(quietly)
Or.

GLORIA
Or what?

CURTIS
Or she'll finally feel safe enough to say yes.
(beat)
Glo. That girl's been fighting the whole world with eleven dollars in the bank for three years. Her brother's gone. Our son showed up once, then showed up with lawyers. We showed up with a petition.
(beat)
She doesn't hate us. She's scared of us. We're the Bakers from Belmont Crest. We're the people who can take things.

Gloria looks at him. Her eyes fill, just slightly.

GLORIA
I've held that baby eleven times,
Curtis. Eleven.

CURTIS
I know.

GLORIA
My mother held me every day of my
life until I was grown. My
granddaughter doesn't know what
my kitchen smells like.

CURTIS
(taking her hand across
the table)
Then let's wait and see what she
does with a little safety.

GLORIA
(beat)
And if she says no?

CURTIS
(beat)
Then Stanley does his job.

Gloria nods slowly. She picks up the phone on the wall and
dials.

GLORIA
(into phone)
Stanley. It's Gloria Baker.
(beat)
No. Don't file anything. Not yet.
(beat)
But have it ready.

Curtis lets out a breath. Kiara, earbuds in, keeps doing
her geometry. Her pencil has stopped moving.

CUT TO:

18 INT. BELLE RIVE – NATASHA'S STUDY – NIGHT
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 6:58 PM EST

The peacock-blue study. Natasha stands at the window in
her crimson suit, phone to her ear. Below, in the motor
court, Robert's Mercedes pulls in.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(filtered)

Robert J. Bullock. Zero reservations at any Donohue property since 1999, ma'am. Not one. Not even a business lunch billed to a room.

NATASHA
(watching the Mercedes park)
Zero.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
Camille A. Rhodes. Fourteen reservations between March 1999 and February 2000. The Donohue Savannah, the Donohue Sea Island, and twice at the Donohue Buckhead. Always a suite. Always two keys. Always a Thursday night.

Natasha closes her eyes.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Paid in cash at checkout. Every time.

NATASHA
(evenly)
And after February 2000?

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
Nothing, ma'am. She stopped using our properties entirely. Not one night in almost five years.

A beat. Natasha opens her eyes.

NATASHA
Somebody told her to stop.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
That's how I'd read it, ma'am.

NATASHA
Because somebody realized the front desk at a Donohue hotel reports to Natasha Donohue.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(carefully)
Yes, ma'am.

Below, Robert gets out of the Mercedes with his briefcase. He stops in the motor court and looks up at the house, at her window. She doesn't step back. He can't see her through the glare.

NATASHA
Thursday nights, Nathaniel.
Always Thursdays?

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
Every one.
(beat)
Ma'am. If they moved to another
chain, I can't see their system.

NATASHA
(beat)
Then get outside your system.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(beat)
Ma'am?

NATASHA
You know people at the
Ritz-Carlton. You know people at
the Four Seasons, the
InterContinental, the St. Regis.
You've hired half of their
security staff away from them
over the years.
(beat)
Find out where Camille Rhodes
sleeps on Thursday nights. And
tell me the next one before it
happens.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)
(beat)
Yes, Mrs. Bullock.

She hangs up. Downstairs, the front door opens and closes.

ROBERT (O.S.)
(calling up the stairs,
warm)
Tash? I'm home.

Natasha looks at the phone in her hand. She sets it down.
She checks her lipstick in the dark window.

NATASHA
(calling, bright)
In here, baby!

CUT TO:

19 INT. HARMONY'S TOWNHOUSE – LINDBERGH – LIVING ROOM – NIGHT

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 7:36 PM EST

The little townhouse. Lyric, in pajamas, is asleep on the couch with her giraffe, worn out from Ravenhurst. The navy St. John jacket hangs carefully on the back of a dining chair.

Harmony, in sweatpants, eats cold Chinese food from a carton at the table, surrounded by Smilley acquisition binders.

The DOORBELL rings.

She freezes. She checks Lyric. Asleep. She goes to the door and looks through the peephole.

A FLORIST DELIVERY MAN (40s) holds an enormous arrangement: white peonies, in January.

She opens the door.

FLORIST DELIVERY MAN
Harmony Divine?

HARMONY
(suspicious)
Who's it from?

FLORIST DELIVERY MAN
There's a card, ma'am.

She takes the flowers. He goes. She closes the door with her hip and sets them on the dining table between the binders.

White peonies. Dozens. They smell like spring.

She plucks the small card from the stems. It's handwritten in a strong, square hand she's only seen on lawyers' documents and one birthday card.

INSERT – THE CARD: "Proud of you. – A."

Harmony reads it. She reads it again.

HARMONY
(to herself)
No.

She marches to the kitchen trash can with the card and holds it over the bin.

She stands there.

She doesn't drop it.

From the couch, Lyric stirs.

LYRIC
(sleepy)
Mama. Flowers.

HARMONY
Go back to sleep, baby.

LYRIC
(eyes closing)
Daddy flowers.

Harmony looks at her daughter. At the card.

She takes a magnet off the refrigerator, a FIND DEE magnet, and pins the card to the fridge door, beside Lyric's crayon drawings.

She stands back and looks at it.

HARMONY
(quietly)
Doesn't mean anything.

She goes back to the binders. She doesn't read them. She looks at the peonies.

Her cell phone buzzes. A text. E.O.S.:

INSERT – THE TEXT: "9 AM. Auburn Ave. Wear flats. We're walking."

Harmony types back with her thumb: "ok boss."

Then, after a beat, a second text: "he sent flowers."

The reply comes in two seconds.

INSERT – THE TEXT: "Did you throw them out?"

Harmony looks at the peonies. She types: "they're peonies. in january."

A long pause. The phone stays silent.

Then: "Keep the flowers. Don't call him."

Harmony laughs quietly. She sets down the phone.

CUT TO:

20 INT. SMILLEY TOWER — 69TH FLOOR — DESMOND'S OFFICE — NIGHT

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 8:02 PM EST

A sleek, minimalist office. Black leather, chrome, and a single Basquiat on the wall that Desmond bought in 1983 for eleven thousand dollars. Bloomberg screens glow.

DESMOND SMILLEY sits behind his desk with a glass of cognac, reading a thin folder. Luke stands in front of the desk, still furious.

LUKE

You abstained.

DESMOND

(turning a page)

I did.

LUKE

You've been telling me for a year that Esther will ruin this company. And today, when it counted, you folded your hands.

DESMOND

(closing the folder, patiently)

Nephew. Sit down.

Luke sits. Desmond pours him a cognac he didn't ask for and slides it across the desk.

DESMOND (CONT'D)

If I had voted no today, what would have happened?

LUKE

We'd have had twenty-eight against fifty.

DESMOND

And your grandmother would still have voted yes, and Esther would still have won, seventy to twenty-eight. And every person at that table would've known exactly where I stand.

(beat)

Instead, they know nothing. Your father doesn't know. Your grandmother doesn't know. Esther certainly doesn't know.

(sipping)

A man who doesn't show his hand can't lose it.

LUKE

(beat)

So where do you stand?

DESMOND

(smiling)

Drink your cognac.

Luke drinks. Desmond watches him.

DESMOND (CONT'D)

Did you notice anything at the table today?

LUKE

(beat)

Delphine says Father voted left-handed.

DESMOND

Your sister is more observant than she lets on.

(beat)

Anything else?

LUKE

No.

DESMOND

(nodding, as if confirming something)

No.

He opens a drawer and puts the folder inside. Luke catches a glimpse of the tab: DONOHUE – OLSON.

LUKE
What's that?

DESMOND
Homework.
(beat)
Tomorrow night I'm having a drink
with someone who may be able to
help us with our Esther problem.

LUKE
Who?

DESMOND
Someone who has the same problem.
(standing, buttoning
his jacket)
Go home, Luke. Kiss your wife.
Tell her she's getting her
country-club membership. Noelle
likes to hear it.

LUKE
(standing)
Is she?

DESMOND
Everybody gets what they want
eventually, nephew.
(the tiniest pause)
If they're patient.

Luke goes. Desmond stands alone at his window, looking
across Peachtree at Donohue Tower. On the 86th floor, one
office is still lit.

He raises his cognac to it.

FADE OUT.

ACT FIVE

21 INT. RAVENHURST – THE LIBRARY – NIGHT*Tuesday, January 11, 2005 – 8:47 PM EST*

A two-story French library: carved oak galleries, a spiral staircase, a fire in a stone hearth, and an enormous antique desk.

Esther sits at the desk in a silk robe, barefoot, her hair down, with a sheet of engraved stationery in front of her. E.O.S. Beside it, a wastebasket already holding three crumpled sheets.

Crowe stands in front of the desk, in his suit, as always.

CROWE

The first PI starts on BSI tomorrow. Public filings, government contracts, offshore subsidiaries, their Pentagon work, their Sri Lanka operation. Nothing on the CEO.

ESTHER

(not looking up)
Nothing on the CEO.

CROWE

Understood, ma'am.
(beat)
Ma'am. One more thing. Your uncle had a folder pulled from our Chicago archive today. On the Donohues and the Olsons.

Esther's pen stops.

ESTHER

My uncle has always been interested in the Donohues.

CROWE

He asked for it by courier. From Chicago. Tonight.
(beat)
He's meeting someone at the Ritz-Carlton tomorrow night at nine. His assistant booked a corner table in the bar under the name "D. Smith."

ESTHER
(beat)
Who's he meeting?

CROWE
I don't know yet.

ESTHER
Find out.

CROWE
Yes, ma'am.

He goes. The door closes.

Esther looks down at the stationery. "Dear Mrs. Donohue,"
at the top. Nothing else.

She picks up a small folded piece of paper from the corner
of the desk. She unfolds it: Victoria's crayon drawing.
The big grinning face. The enormous teeth.

"FUNNY MAN."

She looks at it for a long time. Then she folds it back
up, very carefully, and slips it into the desk drawer.

She picks up her fountain pen, and this time she writes
without stopping.

INSERT – THE STATIONERY, Esther's elegant hand:

"Dear Mrs. Donohue,

Thank you for your kind invitation and your welcome. I
came to your gate twice. I'm sorry I didn't come in.

It wasn't a lack of respect. It was the opposite.

With my grandmother's regards, and my own,

Esther Odessa Smilley"

She blots it. She reads it once. Her hand is shaking a
little.

She folds it into a cream envelope, writes "Mrs. Alexander
J. Donohue – The Dowager House" on the front, and seals
it.

She rings a small silver bell on the desk. A MAID appears
at the door.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
Ask Wallace to take this across
the wall in the morning. By hand.
To the Dowager House. Before
eight.

(beat)
He's to give it to Mrs. Donohue's
butler and leave. He's not to
wait for an answer.

The maid takes it and goes.

Esther sits back in the big chair. She looks into the
fire.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
(to herself, barely a
whisper)
"It was the opposite."

She closes her eyes.

CUT TO:

22 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE LIBRARY — NIGHT
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 9:44 PM EST

Night six. The fire. The Chesterfield. The quilt, folded.

Victor sits in his armchair, still in his suit trousers
and shirtsleeves, with a stack of courier logs across his
lap. Reading glasses on. Anna Karenina is face-down on the
side table. He's done with the train.

The door opens. Joan, in her robe, carrying a tray with
the chamomile. And this time, two cups.

Victor sees the two cups. He sets down the logs.

VICTOR
(carefully)
Two cups.

JOAN
Don't read into it.

VICTOR
I'm reading into it.

She sets down the tray and pours two cups. She sits in the
chair across from him, the first time in six nights.

JOAN

Your mother says you'll make seven.

VICTOR

My mother is keeping a list.

JOAN

She's keeping a scoreboard.
(beat, nodding at the logs)
What's that?

VICTOR

(beat)
Courier logs.

JOAN

You're reading courier logs at ten o'clock at night.

VICTOR

Somebody used my office, Joan.

She sets down her cup.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

In October. My letterhead. My stamp. Somebody requested files from Donohue Shipping in my name. And somebody wrote a letter to a bank in Savannah in my name.
(beat)
I didn't write either one.

JOAN

(quietly)
The FBI file.

VICTOR

The FBI file.

JOAN

Who has access to your stamp?

VICTOR

My secretary. My chief of staff. Anybody on the eighty-eighth floor who walks past Mrs. Ames's desk while she's at lunch.
(beat)
Anybody in the family with a badge for the elevator.

Joan absorbs that.

JOAN

(beat)

Then someone in your house is
lying to you.

VICTOR

Someone in my house has been
lying to me for a while, I think.

(beat)

I just didn't want to know who.

Joan looks at her husband. Sixty-eight years old in
shirtsleeves with courier logs in his lap, and for the
first time in forty-five years, he looks a little afraid.

She reaches across and takes his hand.

JOAN

Tomorrow's night seven.

VICTOR

I know.

JOAN

(beat)

Thursday, you're coming back to
bed.

VICTOR

(looking at her)

Is that a ruling, Judge?

JOAN

It's a ruling.

(beat)

And whoever's been in your house,
Victor, you find them. And then
you let me decide what we do
about them.

VICTOR

(beat)

Why you?

JOAN

Because you'll want to forgive
them if they're family.

(beat)

And I won't.

She squeezes his hand and lets it go. She stands and takes her cup. At the door she stops.

JOAN (CONT'D)
Drink your tea. It's still the
good chamomile.

She goes. Victor looks at his tea. At the logs.

He picks up the top page. His finger runs down the October column and stops on a line.

INSERT — THE LOG: "10/14/04 — 3:22 PM — PKG FROM DONOHUE SHIPPING (SAVANNAH) — SIGNED FOR: 'M.' — DELIVERED TO: 88TH FL. RECEPTION."

A single initial. "M."

Victor stares at it.

CUT TO:

23 INT. THE BULLOCK PAVILION — MARC'S STUDY — NIGHT

Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 10:21 PM EST

Marc's glass-walled study: a wall of books, a chessboard mid-game, a view down the dark bluff to the Chattahoochee. Alexander's pocket watch lies open on the desk, ticking.

Marc sits in the dark except for the desk lamp. In front of him, side by side:

The photocopy of the Harbour Point designation letter. "OFFICE OF THE CHAIRMAN." The red stamp: "V. DONOHUE — CHAIRMAN."

And his laptop, open. The frozen gate-camera image of Esther Smilley in scarlet, leaning toward the guardhouse glass.

He looks from one to the other.

His phone buzzes on the desk. AMOND.

MARC
(answering)
Yeah.

AMOND (V.O.)
(filtered)
I sent Harmony flowers.

MARC
(beat)
Okay.

AMOND (V.O.)
Peonies. The florist said they
don't come in January. I told him
to find some.

MARC
(a small smile)
Did she throw them out?

AMOND (V.O.)
I don't know. She didn't call.
(beat)
Marc. Harmony's best friend is
Esther Smilley.

MARC
I know. Mama told me on speaker,
remember?

AMOND (V.O.)
And Lyric was at Ravenhurst
today. Playing with the twins.
Kiara saw it on CrestWatch.
There's a picture. Somebody shot
it through the morning-room
window with a long lens. That
paparazzo, probably.
(beat)
The three of them in a row on a
quilt. Our kid and Esther
Smilley's kids.
(beat)
I'm looking at it right now. You
should see it. They could be
sisters.

Marc's eyes go to the laptop. Esther's face on the gate
camera.

MARC
(quietly)
Send it to me.

AMOND (V.O.)
Why?

MARC
(beat)
I want to see my goddaughter.

AMOND (V.O.)

(beat)

Okay. Night, Marc.

MARC

Night, Mond.

He hangs up. A moment later, the laptop chimes. An email from Amond. An attachment.

Marc clicks it.

A grainy photo, taken through a hedge and a window: three little girls on a quilt in a sunny French room. Lyric in purple with her giraffe. Two identical little girls in velvet dresses, one of them mid-laugh, her head thrown back.

Marc looks at the laughing twin.

He leans closer to the screen. He doesn't know why.

On the desk, Alexander's watch ticks.

He looks at the laughing girl for a long time. Then he closes the laptop gently, as if something inside it might wake up.

CUT TO:

24 INT. CARLA MIMS'S HOUSE — DECATUR — KITCHEN — NIGHT
Tuesday, January 11, 2005 — 10:52 PM EST

A small, tidy ranch-house kitchen in Decatur. Formica counters. A GBI retirement plaque on the wall next to a church calendar. A police scanner murmurs low on top of the refrigerator.

Carla sits at the kitchen table in a housecoat, reading glasses on her nose, a cup of Sanka at her elbow. Her husband's snoring drifts from down the hall.

The Northside Drive map is spread across the table. Dee's photo is propped against the sugar bowl.

She has Bernadette Sinclair's January 3, 2002 column in her hand. Out of the plastic sleeve now. She's reading the whole thing. Every word. The way she reads everything.

CARLA

(murmuring, reading)

"...the Hendersons' black-tie extravaganza at 3244 Northside... sixteen-piece orchestra... the champagne was Cristal, and the guest list was a who's who of Belmont Crest..."

She turns the clipping over to the photo spread. She pulls a magnifying glass from her canvas bag. She holds it over the tiny captions.

CARLA (CONT'D)
(reading captions, one by one)
"Dr. and Mrs. Walter Henderson welcome their guests."
"Councilman and Mrs. Leon Hardaway." "Media mogul Franklin Cummings and Dr. Yvette Cummings..."

She stops.

She moves the magnifying glass one photo over. A young woman in a silver gown, laughing, a champagne flute raised, her arm around a friend.

CARLA (CONT'D)
(reading, slowly)
"...and their daughter, Arianna, 19, the newly minted Emory Law graduate, who told this columnist she was 'the designated driver, darling, I promise.'"

Carla lowers the magnifying glass.

She looks at the photograph without it. The laughing girl in silver.

Then she looks at the photo of Dee propped against the sugar bowl.

Then back.

She sits very still. The scanner murmurs. Down the hall, her husband snores.

She picks up her red marker.

On the map, she draws a red circle around 3244 NORTHSIDE DRIVE. The Hendersons'.

Then she draws a second, smaller circle, very neatly,
around the caption in the clipping.

She caps the marker. She takes off her reading glasses and
lets them fall on their beaded chain.

CARLA (CONT'D)
(quietly, to Dee's
picture)
Well.
(beat)
She did tell me she was at a
party.

HOLD on the two red circles.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0007

NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

- It's MAMA DEE's 54th birthday. At Dee's Kitchen, two arrangements arrive: one from "a friend," and one from SILAS, with a card: "No black lilies."
- At the Dowager House, SIMONE opens a cream envelope, reads one line twice, and smiles: "It was the opposite."
- At Velvet, MALLORY meets the DJ everybody's talking about. He won't tell her his name. "Just Q." Across town, at the Ritz-Carlton bar, MARTIN sits down across from DESMOND SMILLEY: "It seems we have the same problem."

FADE TO BLACK.